Ellie Barrett

Senior UX Designer

I untangle ambiguity to create accessible, research-led products that drive results.

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SKILLS

User research · Usability testing · Stakeholder interviews · Information architecture · Content modelling · Interaction design · User flows · Wireframing · Prototyping · Design systems · WCAG 2.2 AA · Inclusive design · Heuristic evaluation · Card sorting · Workshop facilitation · CRO strategy · Responsive design · Figma · Miro · HTML / CSS · Adobe Creative Suite

EDUCATION

PGCE with QTS, Computer Science
University of East London
2020 – 2021

BA (Hons) Digital Arts
University of Kent, Year in Industry
2016 – 2020

Speech Link Prize: Best Therapeutic Application Design, 2020

CertHE Illustration
UCA Farnham
2014 – 2016

Extended Diploma, Art & Design
UCA Maidstone (Level 3 UAL)
2012 – 2014

PROFILE

Senior UX Designer with six years of UX experience across internships, agency work and my current role at Yoyo Design, where I've led UX since 2022. I've built research and design processes from scratch and embedded them across multidisciplinary teams, taking projects from discovery through to handoff-ready UI.

My specialism is accessible, inclusive design to WCAG 2.2 AA, with a focus on neurodivergent and partially sighted users. I'm drawn to organisations with a real communication challenge, where research changes the outcome rather than just validating it.

EXPERIENCE

Senior UX Designer — Jan 2022 – Present
Yoyo Design, digital agency. Promoted from UX Designer in 2022.

- Lead UX across charity, NGO, ed-tech and sustainability projects for clients including Worldwide Cancer Research, Fight for Sight, Marie Curie and GIFCT.
- Built the agency's research and design processes and embedded them across project teams.
- Deliver accessible WCAG 2.2 AA products, including screen reader optimisation, keyboard navigation and accessible colour systems.
- Run stakeholder interviews, usability testing, heuristic evaluations and card sorting to drive evidence-based decisions.
- Build design systems and work closely with developers, PMs and clients through build, facilitating workshops in Miro.

Teacher of Computing and Business — Sep 2020 – Nov 2021
Walderslade Girls' School / Hillview School for Girls

- Taught Computer Science and Business to secondary students, planning and delivering lessons and managing assessment.

UX Research Intern — Jun 2020 – Sep 2020
Yoyo Design

- Supported user research across client projects, contributing to synthesis and documentation.

UX Design Intern, Year in Industry — Aug 2018 – Aug 2019
Zebra Technologies, London

- Supported UX design in a global in-house team, building prototypes in Sketch and presenting them through InVision.
- Produced web assets with Adobe Creative Suite and assisted with client and market research.

KEY PROJECTS

HEALTH CHARITY / WEBSITE REDESIGN

Worldwide Cancer Research

Full website redesign as UX lead, from discovery and stakeholder research through IA and UI to launch. Restructured the site around distinct donor and researcher journeys, with bespoke donation components and impact storytelling.

- ▲ £1,157 / month in donations
- ▲ 18.6% users
- ▲ 19.6% session duration

ONLINE SAFETY / RESEARCH TOOLS

Global Internet Forum to Counter Terrorism

Three interconnected research tools for comparing terrorism legislation across jurisdictions, built for policy makers and trust-and-safety teams. Three audience groups, 40+ content types and two partner organisations, delivered in around two months.

- 80% of users reported faster research
- #1 most adopted GIFCT release
- Global summit launch

ACTIVE TRAVEL / INCLUSIVE PRODUCT RESEARCH

Walk Wheel Cycle Trust

Pan-impairment mapping tool designed with Transport for All and an embedded expert panel of disabled volunteers. Personas built to surface conflicting needs, a comparator audit and a high-fidelity prototype ready for volunteer testing.

- £1mil+ funding unlocked
- 5 mapping tools audited
- Findings report delivered

SIGHT LOSS CHARITY / MERGER AND REDESIGN

Fight for Sight

Merged two charities' content estates into one accessible site for blind and partially sighted people, carers, donors and researchers. Tested with screen reader and magnification users, leading to a persistent accessibility toolbar.

- ▲ 70% donation page traffic
- ▲ 533% newsletter sign-ups
- ▲ £10k income in year one

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Freelance Illustrator 2013 – 2023

- Illustrated two published books, plus commissions for Central London firms and small businesses.

Systems Executive Apr 2016 – Sep 2016

Portafina, Gillingham

- Administrative support role between UCA Farnham and starting my BA at the University of Kent.